

After you run this command, the content of *yourScript.py* will be formatted according to Black's style guide.

Your `PATH` environment variable might already be set up to run Black directly, in which case you can format *yourScript.py* by simply entering the following:

```
C:\Users\Al>black yourScript.py
```

If you want to run Black over every *.py* file in a folder, specify a single folder instead of an individual file. The following Windows example formats every file in the *C:\yourPythonFiles* folder, including its subfolders:

```
C:\Users\Al>python -m black C:\yourPythonFiles
```

Specifying the folder is useful if your project contains several Python files and you don't want to enter a command for each one.

Although Black is fairly strict about how it formats code, the next three subsections describe a few options that you *can* change. To see the full range of options that Black offers, run `python -m black --help`.

Adjusting Black's Line Length Setting

The standard line of Python code is 80 characters long. The history of the 80 character line dates back to the era of punch card computing in the 1920s when IBM introduced punch cards that had 80 columns and 12 rows. The 80 column standard remained for the printers, monitors, and command line windows developed over the next several decades.

But in the 21st century, high-resolution screens can display text that is more than 80 characters wide. A longer line length can keep you from having to scroll vertically to view a file. A shorter line length can keep too much code from crowding on a single line and allow you to compare two source code files side by side without having to scroll horizontally.

Black uses a default of 88 characters per line for the rather arbitrary reason that it is 10 percent more than the standard 80 character line. My